

The Unpersuadables: Your Mental Models of Investing

“**W**^{HAT THE HELL is wrong with those people?”}

If events of recent years have you asking yourself that question, consider an unexpected answer: *Not very much.*

If you are shocked by what you hear from the more extreme, offensive people on social media, in politics, or in the media, consider that many of these people suffer from a small but *crucial* error in the way their brains create foundational models of the world around them. This is the conclusion of Will Storr’s *The Unpersuadables: Adventures with the Enemies of Science*.^{[390](#)}

Storr embeds himself with people many of us might describe as eccentric if not disturbed. UFO abductees, Holocaust deniers, new earth creationists, medicine-eschewing homeopaths, meditation gurus, extreme yogis, skeptics, and past-life regression therapists are among those whose world views he closely examines.

What is striking about all the people embracing unorthodox views isn’t that they are insane, but rather *that they seem normal*. They are high-functioning individuals who, for reasons the book only hints at, have a deep flaw in their psychological understanding of how the world works. The book shows how our models affect not just how we see the world but impact our cognitive processes, too.

Like a rocket sent to Mars, if you are off a few inches at launch, you will miss the planet by millions of miles. So, too, with those people whose models have a large, fatal flaw at its core.

What is *off* with these people? In many ways, they suffer from many of the cognitive failings we all succumb to: They are deeply tribal; they construct storylines to help make sense of the world; when evidence is presented in